

2c. Content of Debates in contemporary society: (03)

This component engages learners in theoretical debates and how these relate to a contemporary global society. The component will develop knowledge and understanding of social processes and social change. It develops links between the topics studied in this component, the nature of sociological thought, contemporary social policy and the core themes. Contemporary and global debates are introduced

through a compulsory topic of 'Globalisation and the digital social world' in Section A, whilst Section B explores them in more depth from a detailed study of **one** of three options: either Crime and deviance, Education, or Religion, belief and faith.

The following tables outline the content that must be studied. This is split into two sections, Section A and Section B.

Section A: Globalisation and the digital social world		
Key questions	Content	Learners should:
1. What is the relationship between globalisation and digital forms of communication?	Definitions of globalisation Developments in digital forms of communication in a global society: - digital revolution - global village - networked global society - media convergence - social media - virtual communities - digital social networks Applying sociological theories to digital forms of communication: - Marxism - feminism - postmodernism	be aware of the problems with defining globalisation. consider how developments in digital communication are related to social capital. have an overview of how developments in digital forms of communication have been theoretically interpreted.
2. What is the impact of digital forms of communication in a global context?	The impact of digital forms of communication on: - people's identity - social inequalities - relationships The impact of digital forms of communication on culture: - conflict and change - cultural homogenisation - cultural defence/ 'glocalisation'	consider people's identity and social inequalities in relation to: - social class - gender - age consider both the positive and negative impacts of digital forms of communication.